

Module 2: Understanding the Operating System (Windows 11 Focus)

✓ 1. What is Windows?

Windows is an operating system (OS) developed by **Microsoft** that acts as a bridge between the user and the computer's hardware. It provides a **Graphical User Interface (GUI)** that allows users to interact using icons, buttons, and menus instead of typing commands.

◆ Features:

- Desktop and taskbar
- Drag-and-drop functionality
- Easy file and folder management
- Compatibility with thousands of apps

💡 Example:

When you turn on a computer, the screen showing the wallpaper, icons like "This PC" or "Recycle Bin", and the taskbar at the bottom — all are part of Windows.

✓ 2. Starting, Shutting Down, Restarting, and Sleep Mode

◆ Starting the Computer:

- Press the **Power button** on the CPU or laptop.
- Windows OS loads and displays the **login screen or desktop**.

◆ Shutting Down:

- Click on **Start** → **Power** → **Shut down**.
- Safely turns off the system and closes all programs.

◆ Restarting:

- Use **Start** → **Power** → **Restart**.
- Restarts the computer, useful after updates or software installations.

◆ Sleep Mode:

- Pauses activity and saves power without fully shutting down.
- Resume by pressing any key or moving the mouse.

💡 Example:

If your PC is idle for long, it may enter sleep mode automatically. When you return, you can continue where you left off.

✓ 3. Taskbar Overview

The **Taskbar** is the horizontal bar usually found at the bottom of the screen in Windows.

◆ Main Parts of Taskbar:

- **Start Button:** Opens the Start Menu with apps and settings.
- **Search Bar:** Lets you search apps or files.
- **Pinned Apps:** Quick access to frequently used programs.
- **Notification Area/System Tray:** Shows time, battery, Wi-Fi, and other system icons.
- **Show Desktop Button** (bottom-right corner): Minimizes all open windows.

💡 Example:

You can pin Microsoft Word or Chrome on the taskbar for quick access.

✓ 4. What is a File and Folder?

◆ File:

A **file** is a digital document or piece of data stored in a computer. Each file has a **name and extension** (like `.docx`, `.jpg`, `.mp3`).

Example: `Resume.docx`, `HolidayPhoto.jpg`

◆ Folder:

A **folder** is like a digital container used to store multiple files or other folders (called **subfolders**) to keep things organized.

Example:

A folder named `Class 10 Notes` may contain:

- `English.docx`
 - `Math.pdf`
 - `Science.pptx`
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✓ 5. Creating, Renaming, and Deleting Folders

◆ Creating a Folder:

1. Right-click on the Desktop or inside any directory.
2. Select **New** → **Folder**.
3. A folder named "**New Folder**" appears.
4. Type a name and press Enter.

💡 Example:

Create a folder named `Homework` to store all your assignments.

◆ Renaming a Folder:

1. Right-click the folder you want to rename.
2. Click **Rename**.
3. Type the new name and press Enter.

💡 Example:

Change `New Folder` to `Project Files`.

◆ Deleting a Folder:

1. Right-click the folder.
2. Select **Delete**.

3. It moves to the **Recycle Bin**.
4. To remove it permanently, empty the Recycle Bin.

Example:

If you no longer need a folder called `Old Exams`, delete it to free up space.

Summary Table:

Task	Action	Example
Start Windows	Press Power Button	Booting the computer
Shut Down	Start → Power → Shut down	End your work session
Folder Creation	Right-click → New → Folder	<code>My Documents</code>
Rename Folder	Right-click → Rename	<code>New Folder</code> → <code>Images</code>
Delete Folder	Right-click → Delete	Send <code>Unused</code> to Recycle Bin

6. File Explorer Navigation

File Explorer is the tool used to view, manage, and organize files and folders in Windows.

◆ **How to Open File Explorer:**

- Click on the **Folder icon** on the taskbar.
- Or press **Windows Key + E**.

◆ **Key Components:**

- **Navigation Pane (Left)** – Shows drives, folders like "Documents", "Downloads", "This PC".
- **Address Bar (Top)** – Shows your current folder location.
- **Search Bar** – Helps find files/folders within the opened directory.
- **Details Pane** – Shows information like file size, date modified.

Example:

To open a PDF in "Downloads", navigate via:

`This PC → Downloads → Double-click your file`

✓ 7. Opening and Closing Applications

◆ Opening Apps:

- Click **Start** → **App name**
- Or **Double-click the app icon** on Desktop or Taskbar.
- Use **Search bar** in Start to quickly find apps.

◆ Closing Apps:

- Click the **X button** at the top-right corner of the app window.
- Or press **Alt + F4** on the keyboard.

💡 Example:

To open Microsoft Word:

Start → Search "Word" → Click the result → To close, press **Alt + F4**.

✓ 8. Creating Shortcuts on Desktop

Shortcuts are icons that give quick access to files, folders, or apps from the Desktop.

◆ How to Create:

- **Right-click** a file/app → **Send to** → **Desktop (create shortcut)**
- Or **Drag the item** with right-click → Drop on Desktop → Choose "Create shortcut here"

💡 Example:

You can create a shortcut to your "Class Notes" folder on the desktop for quick access.

✓ 9. Understanding the Recycle Bin

The **Recycle Bin** stores deleted files and folders temporarily.

◆ Key Points:

- Deleted items are **not permanently removed** right away.

- You can **restore** or **permanently delete** from here.
- To empty it, right-click → "**Empty Recycle Bin**".

◆ **Restore Files:**

- Open Recycle Bin → Right-click the item → Select "Restore".



Example:

If you delete a file by mistake, go to Recycle Bin and click **Restore** to recover it.

PRACTICAL

◆ **1. What is Windows?**

1. Identify and note your Windows version (10 or 11).
 2. Open the Start Menu and write down 5 apps listed there.
 3. Locate and list all visible icons on the Desktop.
 4. Open "This PC" and write down the names of available drives.
 5. Customize the desktop background using Personalization settings.
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◆ **2. Starting, Shutting Down, Restarting, Sleep Mode**

1. Shut down the system using the Start Menu.
 2. Restart the system using **Ctrl + Alt + Delete**.
 3. Put the system into **Sleep mode** and resume it.
 4. Change the sleep timer in Power Settings.
 5. Create a shutdown shortcut on the Desktop and test it.
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◆ **3. Taskbar Overview**

1. Pin three apps (like Notepad, Calculator, Paint) to the Taskbar.
2. Unpin one of the apps from the Taskbar.
3. Use the "Show Desktop" button to minimize open windows.

4. Use the Search Bar to find and open an app.
 5. Identify 3 icons in the System Tray and describe their function.
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◆ 4. What is a File and Folder?

1. Create three different file types (e.g., .txt, .docx, .jpg).
 2. Open a file using two different methods.
 3. Check and write down the size of any two files.
 4. Sort files in a folder by "Date Modified".
 5. Move a file from one folder to another using drag-and-drop.
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◆ 5. Folder Creation, Renaming, and Deletion

1. Create a folder named `ClassWork` inside the Documents folder.
 2. Create a subfolder named `Assignments` inside `ClassWork`.
 3. Rename `ClassWork` to `MyClassWork`.
 4. Delete the folder `Assignments` and restore it from Recycle Bin.
 5. Permanently delete a folder using **Shift + Delete**.
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◆ 6. File Explorer Navigation

1. Open File Explorer using **Windows + E**.
 2. Navigate to `Downloads` and open a file from there.
 3. Use the address bar to go to `C:\Windows`.
 4. Use the Search bar in File Explorer to find a file named "notes".
 5. Change the view of a folder to "Details" and "Large icons".
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◆ 7. Opening and Closing Applications

1. Open Notepad and type a few words, then close it.
2. Open three apps (e.g., WordPad, Paint, Calculator) and switch using **Alt + Tab**.
3. Close an app using the title bar (X) and **Alt + F4**.

4. Pin Paint to the Start Menu and open it from there.
 5. Open Task Manager and close an unresponsive app.
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◆ 8. Creating Shortcuts on Desktop

1. Create a shortcut for Chrome (or any browser) on the Desktop.
 2. Rename the shortcut to "My Browser".
 3. Create a shortcut to a specific file (e.g., PDF or DOCX).
 4. Move a shortcut into a new folder named `My Shortcuts`.
 5. Create a shortcut to a website like `www.bing.com`.
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◆ 9. Understanding the Recycle Bin

1. Delete a file and verify it is in the Recycle Bin.
2. Restore the file from the Recycle Bin to its original location.
3. Empty the Recycle Bin and confirm the file is permanently gone.
4. Right-click on Recycle Bin and view its properties.
5. Delete multiple files and restore only one of them.